

Completion Letter

Completion Letter

Document ID	Version	Owner	Effective Date	Framework	Classification
[DOC-SWIFT-IAF-ATT EST-001]	1.0	[Information Security / Compliance Owner]	[DD MMM YYYY]	SWIFT Customer Security Controls Framework	Confidential

Purpose

This Completion Letter provides formal confirmation by the Lead Assessor that the independent assessment activities for [Organisation Name]'s SWIFT Customer Security Controls Framework implementation have been completed for the assessment period stated in this document.

The purpose of this attestation is to confirm that:

- The assessment was performed by an appropriately authorised Lead Assessor.
- The assessment covered the relevant SWIFT environment, supporting systems, processes, and governance arrangements within the defined scope.
- Sufficient evidence was reviewed to support the Lead Assessor's conclusion.
- The assessment outcome has been communicated to management and is ready to support internal governance, external assurance, and SWIFT-related compliance activities.

This document is intended to be used as a formal completion confirmation. It does not replace the detailed assessment workpapers, evidence records, management responses, or any separate remediation tracking documents.

Scope

This attestation applies to the assessment of [Organisation Name]'s implementation of the SWIFT Customer Security Controls Framework for the following environment and period.

Scope Item	Description
Organisation	[Organisation Name]
SWIFT BIC or service identifier	[BIC / Service Identifier]
Assessment period	[Start Date] to [End Date]
Assessment completion date	[DD MMM YYYY]
Lead Assessor	[Lead Assessor Name]
Assessment type	Independent assessment completion confirmation
Primary location(s) assessed	[Office / Data Centre / Cloud Region / Managed Service Location]
Business unit(s) in scope	[Treasury / Payments Operations / IT Operations / Security Operations / Other]
SWIFT connectivity model	[Direct / Service Bureau / Shared Infrastructure / Other]
SWIFT-related systems in scope	[SWIFT interface, middleware, payment application, HSM, jump server, administration workstation, monitoring platform, backup platform]
Third parties in scope	[Service Bureau / Managed Security Provider / Hosting Provider / Network Provider]
Out-of-scope areas	[Any systems, entities, locations, or processes excluded, with rationale]

The assessment considered the governance, technical, operational, and physical security arrangements that support the secure use of SWIFT services by [Organisation Name]. The assessment included, where applicable:

- Logical segregation and protection of the SWIFT environment from general corporate networks.
- Secure configuration and hardening of SWIFT-related infrastructure.
- Access management for users, administrators, operators, and privileged accounts.
- Authentication controls, including multi-factor authentication where required by the organisation's SWIFT architecture.
- Malware protection, system monitoring, and security event handling.
- Management of vulnerabilities, patching, and secure change.
- Logging, alerting, and review of security-relevant activity.
- Backup, recovery, and operational resilience arrangements.
- Incident response processes for SWIFT-related security events.
- Physical protection of systems and locations supporting SWIFT operations.
- Governance, accountability, policy coverage, risk management, and management oversight.
- Evidence supporting self-attestation and ongoing control operation.

The assessment was performed using a combination of document review, inquiry, walkthroughs, sampling, observation, and technical evidence inspection. Testing depth was based on risk, control criticality, system relevance, and the availability of supporting evidence.

Attestation Statement

I, [Lead Assessor Name], acting as Lead Assessor for the SWIFT Customer Security Controls Framework assessment of [Organisation Name], confirm that the assessment activities assigned to me have been completed for the scope and period described in this Completion Letter.

Based on the assessment procedures performed and the evidence made available, I confirm that:

- The assessment was planned and executed using a structured assurance approach appropriate to the size, complexity, and SWIFT connectivity model of [Organisation Name].
- The in-scope SWIFT environment, relevant supporting systems, and associated operational processes were reviewed against the organisation's stated SWIFT security control implementation.
- Evidence was obtained from system records, configuration extracts, policy documents, procedural documents, access listings, monitoring records, incident records, change records, risk records, management attestations, and interviews with responsible personnel.
- Where controls were determined to be operating effectively, the conclusion was supported by evidence that was current, relevant, and attributable to the in-scope environment.
- Where gaps, exceptions, evidence limitations, or improvement items were identified, these were documented and communicated to responsible management for review and action.
- Management has been informed of the assessment outcome, including any matters requiring remediation, acceptance, or further validation.
- The assessment workpapers and supporting evidence references are sufficient to demonstrate completion of the assessment activities performed.
- The Lead Assessor has not knowingly omitted any material matter identified during the assessment that would reasonably be expected to affect management's understanding of the organisation's SWIFT control posture.

The overall completion status is recorded below.

Assessment Area	Completion Status	Summary Outcome
Governance and accountability	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
SWIFT architecture and environment definition	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Network segregation and connectivity controls	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Secure configuration and hardening	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Identity and access management	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Privileged access management	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Malware protection and endpoint security	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Vulnerability and patch management	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Logging, monitoring, and alert handling	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Incident response and escalation	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Backup, recovery, and resilience	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Physical and environmental security	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Third-party and service provider oversight	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]
Evidence quality and traceability	[Completed / Completed with exceptions / Not completed]	[Summary]

Lead Assessor conclusion:

> Based on the work performed, I confirm that the assessment for [Organisation Name] has been completed for the defined scope and assessment period. The results, supporting evidence, and any identified exceptions have been documented and are available for management review, remediation tracking, and SWIFT-related assurance purposes.

This attestation is subject to the following limitations:

- The conclusion is based on evidence provided by [Organisation Name] and relevant third parties during the assessment period.
- The assessment provides assurance over the assessed period and does not guarantee future control operation.
- Where sampling was used, conclusions are based on the sampled items and the consistency of supporting control operation.
- The attestation does not certify the absence of security weaknesses, fraud, unauthorised activity, or future compromise.
- Any subsequent changes to architecture, systems, outsourcing arrangements, operating procedures, or key personnel may affect the continued validity of the assessment conclusion.

Signatory & Authority

The Lead Assessor is responsible for confirming completion of the assessment activities and for ensuring that conclusions are supported by appropriate evidence. Management remains responsible for the design, implementation, operation, and ongoing monitoring of SWIFT security controls.

Role	Name	Responsibility
Lead Assessor	[Lead Assessor Name]	Confirms completion of assessment activities and issues this Completion Letter.
Executive Sponsor	[Executive Sponsor Name]	Accepts the assessment outcome on behalf of management and ensures appropriate follow-up.
SWIFT Security Officer / Control Owner	[Control Owner Name]	Coordinates evidence provision and remediation activities.
Information Security Owner	[Information Security Owner Name]	Maintains security governance and oversight for the SWIFT environment.
Technology Owner	[Technology Owner Name]	Ensures technical controls are implemented and maintained.
Operations Owner	[Operations Owner Name]	Ensures operational controls are performed and documented.
Third-Party Relationship Owner	[Third-Party Owner Name]	Oversees applicable service providers supporting SWIFT operations.

By signing this Completion Letter, the Lead Assessor confirms that the assessment has been completed in accordance with the defined scope and that the conclusion stated in this document reflects the evidence reviewed.

Signatory	Name	Title	Signature	Date
Lead Assessor	[Lead Assessor Name]	[Title / Organisation]	[Signature]	[DD MMM YYYY]
Executive Sponsor Acknowledgement	[Executive Sponsor Name]	[Title]	[Signature]	[DD MMM YYYY]
Control Owner Acknowledgement	[Control Owner Name]	[Title]	[Signature]	[DD MMM YYYY]

The Lead Assessor's authority to issue this Completion Letter is based on:

- Appointment by [Organisation Name] to perform or lead the SWIFT security control assessment.
- Independence from day-to-day operation of the controls assessed, or disclosure of any potential impairment to independence.
- Sufficient professional competence and experience in information security, technology risk, payments security, and control assurance.
- Access to relevant stakeholders, documentation, systems evidence, and management representations required to complete the assessment.
- Agreement with management on the assessment scope, assessment period, evidence expectations, and reporting approach.

Any unresolved limitation affecting the Lead Assessor's ability to complete the assessment must be recorded below.

Limitation or Constraint	Impact	Management Response	Resolution Status
[None identified / Description]	[Impact on assessment]	[Response]	[Open / Closed / Accepted]

Evidence Referenced

The Lead Assessor reviewed evidence considered relevant to the in-scope SWIFT environment and supporting control activities. Evidence was evaluated for completeness, accuracy, timeliness, and traceability to the systems, processes, and control owners in scope.

The following evidence categories were referenced during the assessment.

Evidence Category	Examples of Evidence Reviewed	Source Owner	Evidence Period	Reference Location
SWIFT environment inventory	System inventory, network diagrams, data flow diagrams, SWIFT interface inventory, connectivity description	[Technology Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Architecture and segregation	Firewall rules, network zoning evidence, routing diagrams, remote access architecture, jump host configuration	[Network Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Policy and governance	Security policies, SWIFT security procedures, risk acceptance records, governance meeting minutes	[Information Security Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Access management	User listings, administrator listings, joiner-mover-leaver records, access recertification records	[IAM Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Authentication controls	Multi-factor authentication configuration, password settings, privileged account controls, service account records	[IAM / Platform Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Secure configuration	Build standards, hardening baselines, configuration extracts, exception records	[Platform Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Vulnerability and patch management	Vulnerability scans, patch reports, remediation tickets, exception approvals	[Vulnerability Management Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Malware protection	Endpoint protection status, anti-malware policy, detection logs, exclusion approvals	[Security Operations Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Logging and monitoring	Log source inventory, monitoring use cases, alert records, escalation tickets, SIEM evidence	[Security Operations Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Incident response	Incident response plan, SWIFT-specific escalation procedure, tabletop exercise records, incident tickets	[Incident Response Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Change management	Change tickets, approval evidence, implementation records, emergency change records	[Change Manager]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Backup and recovery	Backup schedules, restore test evidence, recovery procedures, resilience test records	[Operations Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Physical security	Access control records, data centre certifications, visitor logs, physical access review evidence	[Facilities / Data Centre Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Third-party oversight	Service provider contracts, assurance reports, responsibility matrices, supplier review records	[Third-Party Relationship Owner]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]
Management representation	Signed management representation, control owner attestations, remediation commitments	[Executive Sponsor]	[Period]	[Repository / Folder / Ticket]

Evidence handling expectations:

- Evidence must be retained in its original form where practical.
- Screenshots must show the system name, relevant configuration or record, date where available, and the account or role used to obtain the evidence where appropriate.

- Extracts from systems must be traceable to the source system and extraction date.
- Evidence containing sensitive information must be protected using approved access controls.
- Any redactions must not remove information required to support the assessment conclusion.
- Evidence received from third parties must be attributable to the relevant provider and service scope.
- Verbal explanations must be supported by documentary or system evidence wherever possible.

The assessment evidence index is maintained at [Evidence Repository Location]. The Lead Assessor confirms that the evidence index has been updated to reflect the evidence relied upon in forming this Completion Letter.

Frequency

This Completion Letter is issued at the conclusion of each formal SWIFT security control assessment cycle, or whenever management requires a formal independent confirmation that assessment activities have been completed.

Trigger	Requirement
Annual SWIFT assessment cycle	A Completion Letter should be issued after assessment activities are complete and before management finalises external or internal assurance submissions.
Material change to SWIFT architecture	A new or updated attestation should be considered where changes affect connectivity, segregation, hosting, administration, outsourcing, or critical security controls.
Major remediation programme completion	A targeted Completion Letter may be issued to confirm completion of reassessment activities for previously identified gaps.
Significant incident or control failure	Management may request a focused completion confirmation following post-incident review or control validation.
Change in service provider	A new assessment completion confirmation should be considered when responsibility for SWIFT operations or security control operation changes materially.
Regulatory, audit, or board request	A Completion Letter may be issued to support oversight, assurance, or governance requirements.

The standard review and issue cycle is as follows.

Activity	Typical Timing	Responsible Party
Confirm assessment scope and stakeholders	[Month / Quarter]	[Compliance Owner]
Collect and validate evidence	[Month / Quarter]	[Control Owners]
Perform assessment fieldwork	[Month / Quarter]	[Lead Assessor]
Discuss preliminary observations	[Month / Quarter]	[Lead Assessor and Management]
Finalise assessment records	[Month / Quarter]	[Lead Assessor]
Issue Completion Letter	[Month / Quarter]	[Lead Assessor]
Track any remediation actions	Ongoing until closure	[Control Owners]
Report status to governance forum	[Monthly / Quarterly]	[Executive Sponsor]

This Completion Letter remains valid for the assessment period stated in the Scope section unless superseded by a subsequent assessment, significant environmental change, or material information that affects the assessment conclusion.

Records & Retention

This Completion Letter and the supporting assessment records are controlled records of [Organisation Name]. They must be retained in a secure repository with access limited to authorised personnel who require the information for governance, assurance, operational, audit, legal, or regulatory purposes.

Record Type	Minimum Retention Period	Record Owner	Storage Location	Access Restrictions
Signed Completion Letter	[Retention Period, e.g., 7 years]	[Compliance Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted to authorised governance, audit, compliance, and security personnel
Assessment plan and scope confirmation	[Retention Period]	[Compliance Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Evidence index	[Retention Period]	[Lead Assessor / Compliance Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Assessment workpapers	[Retention Period]	[Lead Assessor / Compliance Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Management representation	[Retention Period]	[Executive Sponsor]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Control owner attestations	[Retention Period]	[Compliance Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Exception and remediation records	[Retention Period]	[Risk / Compliance Owner]	[GRC Platform / Repository]	Restricted
Meeting minutes and approval records	[Retention Period]	[Governance Secretariat]	[Repository Location]	Restricted
Third-party assurance evidence	[Retention Period]	[Third-Party Relationship Owner]	[Repository Location]	Restricted, subject to contractual confidentiality terms

Records must be protected in line with their confidentiality and business sensitivity. The following requirements apply:

- The signed Completion Letter must be retained as the authoritative record.
- Draft versions must be clearly marked and removed or archived when no longer required.
- Evidence must not be altered after the assessment conclusion, except to correct indexing errors or update retention metadata.
- Any post-issuance clarification must be documented as an addendum and linked to this Completion Letter.
- Distribution must be limited to approved recipients, such as executive management, internal audit, external assessors, SWIFT compliance stakeholders, regulators, or relevant service providers where authorised.
- Records must be recoverable for audit, legal, regulatory, or assurance purposes throughout the retention period.
- Disposal at the end of the retention period must be authorised, documented, and performed securely.
- Where records contain credentials, security configurations, personal data, network details, or sensitive operational information, additional access controls and monitoring must be applied.

Approved distribution list:

Recipient / Group	Purpose	Distribution Method
[Executive Sponsor]	Management acknowledgement and oversight	[Secure email / GRC platform]
[Chief Information Security Officer]	Security governance and risk management	[Secure email / GRC platform]
[SWIFT Security Officer / Control Owner]	Control ownership and follow-up	[Secure email / GRC platform]
[Internal Audit]	Assurance planning and audit evidence	[Secure repository access]
[External Assessor / Auditor, if applicable]	Independent review or validation	[Secure transfer method]
[Regulatory or supervisory body, if applicable]	Formal submission where authorised	[Approved submission channel]
[Service Provider, if applicable]	Remediation or responsibility confirmation	[Contract-approved secure channel]

Any request for access to this Completion Letter or supporting evidence outside the approved distribution list must be reviewed and approved by [Compliance Owner] and [Information Security Owner] before release.